GANDHI ASSASSINATION DELETIONS



Painting by NAROTTAM NARAYAN SHARMA

CLASS 12 : POLITICAL SCIENCE

■ In the first chapter of ***Politics in India Since Independence***, the following paragraphs were deleted under the sub-head, 'Mahatma Gandhi's Sacrifice':

"He (Gandhi) was particularly disliked by those who wanted Hindus to take revenge or who wanted India to become a country for the Hindus, just as Pakistan was for Muslims... Gandhiji thought that these people were misguided... His steadfast pursuit of Hindu-Muslim unity provoked Hindu extremists so much that they made several attempts to assassinate Gandhiji."

"Gandhiji's death had an almost magical effect on the communal situation in the country. Partition-related anger and violence suddenly subsided. The Government of India cracked down on organisations that were spreading communal hatred. Organisations like the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh were banned for some time."

CLASS 12 : HISTORY

■ In ***Themes of Indian History Part III***, the following section was altered. Earlier it read: "Gandhiji was shot dead by a young man. The assassin, who surrendered afterwards, was a Brahmin from Pune named Nathuram Godse, the editor of an extremist Hindu newspaper who had denounced Gandhiji as an appeaser of Muslims." Now it reads: "At his daily prayer meeting on the evening of 30 January, Gandhiji was shot dead by a young man. The assassin, who surrendered afterwards, was Nathuram Godse."

EMERGENCY EDITS

CLASS 12: POLITICAL SCIENCE

■ The chapter titled 'The Crisis of Democratic Order' in ***Politics in India Since Independence*** has been reduced by five pages. The deleted content pertains to the controversial imposition of Emergency by the Indira Gandhi government. It, however, retains excesses such as the arrest of political workers, media restrictions, torture and custodial deaths, and forced sterilisations. It also mentions the Commission of Inquiry set up by the Janata Party government in May 1977.

CLASS 12: SOCIOLOGY

■ This paragraph has been deleted from Chapter 6 of ***Indian Society***: "The Indian people had a brief experience of authoritarian rule during the 'Emergency' enforced between June 1975 and January 1977. Parliament was suspended and new laws were made directly by the government. Civil liberties were revoked and a large number of politically active people were arrested and jailed without trial... When elections were held unexpectedly in early 1977, the people voted overwhelmingly against the ruling Congress Party."